

Subject Code	ENGL523
Subject Title	Second Language Learning
Credit Value	3
Level	5
Pre-requisite / Co-requisite/ Exclusion	N/A
Objectives	The subject provides structured opportunities for participants to explore: a) fundamental aspects of psycholinguistics and first and second language acquisition, with emphasis on the latter; b) learner factors that affect language learning and the nature of the learning process, with particular reference to adolescent second language learning in Hong Kong; and c) implications of the resulting insights for students' own professional practice.
Intended Learning Outcomes	Upon completion of the subject, students will be able to: a) understand main theories of first and second language learning and how these have influenced theories of language teaching b) understand main stages and processes of second language development c) understand various socio-psychological factors that affect second language learning
Subject Synopsis/ Indicative Syllabus	This subject surveys the main theories of first and second language acquisition in relative depth with a focus on English language learning. a) Language development and bilingualism b) Influential models of language acquisition c) Stages and processes of first and second language acquisition d) Factors affecting second language acquisition e) Interlanguage/Learner language f) Second language learning in the classroom
Teaching/Learning Methodology	Teaching and learning will take the form of themed lectures followed by interactive seminars.

Assessment Methods in Alignment with Intended Learning Outcomes	Specific assessment methods/tasks	% weighting	Intended subject learning outcomes to be assessed					
			a	b	c			
	Test	50%	✓	✓	✓			
	Research application paper	45%	✓	✓	✓			
	3. Participation	5%	✓	✓	✓			
	Total	100%						
The test evaluates students’ understanding of main concepts and theories of second language acquisition. The research application paper assesses the depth of students’ knowledge with which they can critically understand certain important issues in second language acquisition that relate to their own professional practice. Participation includes attendance and involvement in class activities and discussions.								
Student Study Effort Required	Class contact:							
	▪ Lectures					39 Hrs.		
	▪ Seminar					0 Hrs.		
	Other student study effort:							
	▪ Private study					45 Hrs.		
	▪ Assignments					28 Hrs.		
	Total student study effort					112 Hrs.		
Reading List and References	<u>Required Textbook</u>							
	Lightbown, P. M. & Spada, N. (2021). <i>How languages are learned</i> . Fourth edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press.							
	<u>Recommended Readings</u>							
	You should also access and read the following books during the course:							
	Brown, H. D. (2007). <i>Principles of language learning and teaching</i> . Fifth edition. White Plains, NY: Pearson Education.							
	Caroll, D. (2008). <i>Psychology of language</i> . Fifth edition. Belmont, CA: Thomson.							
Cummings, I. (2014). <i>Cambridge handbook of communication disorders</i> . Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.								
Cummings, L. (2014). <i>Communication disorders</i> . Houndmills, Basingstoke: Palgrave Macmillan.								

	De Bot, K. Lowie, W. & Verspoor, M. (2005). <i>Second language acquisition: An advanced resource book</i>. London: Routledge. Dornyei, Z. (2001). <i>Motivational strategies in the language classroom</i>. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. Doughty, C. J. & Long, M. (Eds.). (2005). <i>The handbook of second language acquisition</i>. Blackwell. Ellis, R. (2008). <i>The study of second language acquisition</i>. Second edition. Oxford: Oxford University Press. Field, J. (2003). <i>Psycholinguistics: A resource book for students</i>. New York: Routledge. Gass, S.M., Behney, J. & Plonsky, L. (2013). <i>Second language acquisition: An introductory course</i>. Fourth edition. New York and London: Routledge. Hummel, K.M. (2014). <i>Introducing second language acquisition: Perspectives and practices</i>. Chichester: John Wiley & Sons. Mitchell, R., Myles, F. & Marsden, E. (2013). <i>Second language learning theories</i>. Third edition. Abingdon and New York: Routledge. Ortega, L. (2009). <i>Understanding second language acquisition</i>. New York: Routledge. Saville-Troike, M. & Barto, K. (2017). <i>Introducing second language acquisition</i>. Third edition. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press. Slabakova, R. (2016). <i>Second language acquisition</i>. New York: Oxford University Press. <i>Recommended journals:</i> <i>Language Learning</i> <i>Language Teaching Research</i> <i>Modern Language Journal</i> <i>Studies in Second Language Acquisition</i> <i>TESOL Quarterly</i>
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Revised by Prof. Li Shaofeng in August 2024